

If you or someone you know needs food assistance, there are several nationwide resources that can help locate **food pantries, free grocery distributions, community meals, and other emergency food assistance in every U.S. state.** You do not need to know the name of a local organization beforehand—most of these resources allow you to search using a ZIP code or location.

Feeding America operates a nationwide network of regional food banks. Visit **FeedingAmerica.org/Find-Your-Local-Foodbank** and enter your ZIP code or select your state to find the food bank serving your area. Your regional food bank can then direct you to nearby food pantries, mobile food distributions, and meal programs. Keep in mind that a *food bank* generally supplies a network of organizations, while a *food pantry* is often the location where individuals and families actually pick up groceries.

211 is another nationwide starting point. Dial **211** from your phone or visit **211.org** and search under food assistance. Local 211 networks maintain information about food pantries, community meals, food distributions, and other forms of assistance available nearby. Because hours, eligibility requirements, and food availability can change, it's a good idea to contact a pantry before traveling there.

The **USDA National Hunger Hotline** can also help locate nearby food resources. Call **1-866-348-6479 (1-866-3-HUNGRY)** Monday through Friday from 8 a.m.–8 p.m. Eastern, or text **914-342-7744** with a word such as “food” and your ZIP code/location. **USA.gov** also maintains an Emergency Food Assistance page connecting people with emergency food programs and government assistance.

Another useful resource is **Findhelp**, available at **Findhelp.org**. Enter your ZIP code and search for food assistance to find programs serving your area. Findhelp can also be used to search for many other forms of community assistance. If one resource doesn't produce what you need, **try several of them**—local food resources change frequently, and different databases may contain different programs.